
6. Medical professionals

Doctors, nurses, and physical therapists can take advantage of several programs offering loan forgiveness in select geographic areas. By providing services to depressed regions, up to 100% of their loans may be deferred. Additional areas of need include clinical research and dental care.

7. Law

Law students and newly graduated lawyers who offer their services at free and reduced cost can take advantage of partial loan forgiveness. By working for agencies that provide public-interest or nonprofit services, graduates can make a difference in the lives of those who can't afford legal representation. Equal Justice Works (EqualJusticeWorks.org) has more information on these programs.

As the need grows for more professionals to serve our communities, there will be an increasing reward for those who answer the call. Loan forgiveness can be a big motivator toward commitment in these fields. Participation in forgiveness programs can add value to your degree and will make college affordable for thousands more each year. — **Linsey Knerl**

How to Sound More Confident in One Simple Step

I recently took a class on public speaking. It's not something that I thought I needed, but it turns out that I'm a terrible public speaker. Most people are, but I always thought of myself as relatively eloquent. Turns out, it's not so much what you say, but how you say it.

The woman who was teaching our class is a voice artist with over 50 years of experience. The first thing that she taught us actually took pretty much the entire class to learn, and will probably take even longer to master. But it's so simple and important, I felt it needed to be shared.

Own your name

Our teacher told us that when she is in charge of hiring other voice artists based on video résumés, she only has to hear the first line of their introduction to know whether or not she can work with them. This might seem harsh, but it's her methodology, so I'm not going to argue with its validity.